

Master Plan Implementation Committee (MPIC) Solar Subcommittee Meeting

Minutes Thursday, August 1, 2024

Present: Teri Anderson, Susan Bronstein, Jen Milikowsky, Scott Stanton (taking minutes), Doug Finn. Leah Stanton and Robby Armenti also attended for part of the meeting as members of the public.

Call to Order 5:35pm

Jen Milikowsky motion to approve 6-20-24 meeting minutes, Stanton seconded, passed **3 yes, 1 abstention.**

Update to previous information on grid capacity -

Jennifer attended an MMA (MA Municipal Assoc) webinar and received new information that MA DPU (Dept. of Public Utilities) has updated its Net Metering Program Regulations to allow municipal and state solar generating facilities of 60KW or less to qualify under the public cap of the Net Metering Program as a Class 1 facility. Municipalities will have an aggregate generating capacity of 10MW under the cap. Municipal facilities generating more than 60 kilowatts but less than or equal to one megawatt fall under the cap if they provide for on-site load rather than being transferred back into the grid. This means the Town Hall and Public Safety solar systems will be exempt from the electric grid capacity caps for Westhampton.

Review and editing of the Request for Proposals (RFP) -

This RFP will only pertain to the Town Hall and Annex installation, we will be requesting separate proposals for the Safety Complex installation at a later date.

Technical proposals will be kept separate from the price proposals so that Doug Finn, acting as the Chief Procurement Officer can see the pricing while the proposal review committee will only see the technical proposals so that they evaluate the proposals on merit only and not on cost until the very end of the process when they are combined.

At the recommendation of town counsel, we will be utilizing Chapter 30B Procurement Rules for this installation. This RFP only concerns the Town Hall installation because we need to obligate the ARPA funds by the end of the year, but including the Safety Complex installation was discussed with the idea that a larger project might entice more proposals and possibly include a discount for a larger project. In the end we decided we will keep the projects separate for simplicity's sake due to the different timelines.

Northeast Solar's preliminary estimate included prevailing wage, though it is about 6 months old and will need to be updated.

Changed the structural assessment from a separate MOU to a line item in the contract to be carried out by the contractor or a subcontractor.

Doug will revise the draft based on these discussions and send out to solar committee members for final review at a meeting on 8/6. After the committee has finalized the draft RFP, it will be reviewed by counsel.

Next meeting: Tuesday, August 6, 2024 at 5:30pm. In-person meeting at Town Hall.

Meeting adjourned at 8:37pm, unanimously agreed.

Submitted By,
Scott Stanton